

Rational Deceptions? An Analytical Exploration of Tonality, Meter, and Form in C. P. E. Bach's Symphony in D Major, Wq. 183/1

ABSTRACT

This article is an analytical exploration of the first-movement exposition from C. P. E. Bach's Symphony in D major, Wq. 183/1 (of 1775 or 1776). The piece starts with a meter-finding problem (Mirka 2009) and continues on with tonal deceptions akin to those of a free fantasy as described by Bach (1753/1762). When the disruptions subside, the piece closely follows a fairly standard punctuation sequence of a galant exposition, to put it in neo-Kochian terms (Burstein 2020). Compositional ideas that were formerly presented in an improvisatory or ambiguous way now find their resolution or proper place in the course of a conventional galant exposition. In addition to providing an ad hoc, multi-parametric analysis of the exposition and its deceptions and transformations, I also speculate on the possibility that Bach intended this work as a compositional reaction to Kirnberger's (1982 [1771, 1776]) *The Art of Strict Musical Composition*. Bach's explicit reaction to Kirnberger's views on key changes is explored in detail by Ferris (2000), and the present symphony incorporates a fantasy-like harmonic twist that is at odds with Kirnberger's more restrained approach to key shifts. Furthermore, Bach may well be reacting here to Kirnberger's innovative notions of meter (Mirka 2009) and to the latter's conceptions of essential and nonessential dissonance, which are playfully engaged in a contrapuntal exercise segment of the exposition. Whether or not the piece was intended as a hidden theoretical commentary, it gives us an opportunity for an analytical journey through a puzzling exposition.

1. *Rational Tonal Deceptions*

The opening of C. P. E. Bach's extraordinary Symphony in D major, Wq. 183/1, presents an unusual chain of events: a metrically ambiguous and tonally clear passage gives way to another passage that is metrically clear and tonally ambiguous.¹ When preceding ambiguities subside, the music is funneled through a highly conventional Prinner connecting to a HC in the home key, or—in neo-Kochian terms of punctuation form (after Burstein 2020)—a *Quintabsatz* in the home key, serving as a signpost in the course of the exposition. This article is an analytical exploration of a single first-movement exposition. Therefore, I do not set to make sweeping theoretical claims, nor do I take a purely historically-informed stance: this is an opportunity to present an ad-hoc, multi-

¹ The opening of Bach's symphony is analyzed briefly in Yust (2018, 187–8); my article offers a complementary, informal analysis of tonality, meter, and form in this piece.

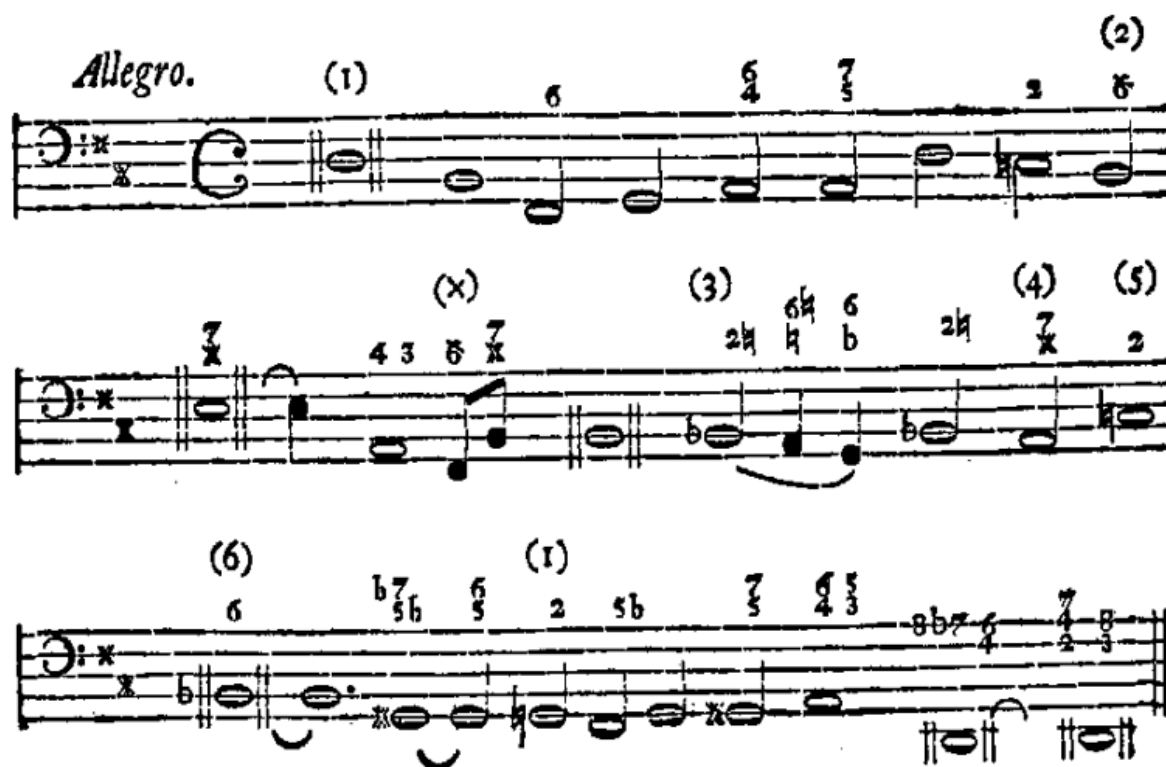
parametric analysis of an idiosyncratic exposition.² I will argue that Bach's fantasy-like opening proposes several ambiguities and compositional problems that are subsequently resolved as the same ideas are revisited in the more conventional sonata-like portion of the exposition. This suggests that Bach's piece is an important precedent for better-known sonata-fantasy hybrids such as Beethoven's Tempest sonata, in which an improvisatory opening turns out to be the proper beginning of the sonata (Hamilton 2008; cf. Schmalfeldt 2011). As I will argue, Bach's approach to this hybridity is to take ambiguous or fantasy-like elements and reinterpret them in the remainder of the exposition in more schematic and formulaic guises.

Bach famously commented on harmonic deceptions at the concluding chapter of the second volume of his keyboard treatise (1762), which deals with improvising a fantasy. Bach explains that one can create expectations of moving in a certain tonal, then frustrating those expectations. Bach's outline is given in Example 1. Bach writes (in William Mitchell's translation): "It is one of the beauties of improvisation to feign modulation to a new key through a formal cadence and then to move off in another direction. This and other rational deceptions make a fantasy attractive; but they must not be excessively used, or natural relationships will become hopelessly buried beneath them."³

² Note that some of the relations discussed below—e.g., the problem of meter finding and entrainment—are likely to be perceived by various kinds of listeners, while others—e.g., punctuation form and galant schemata—would be more meaningful for listeners deeply enculturated in the galant style (i.e., probably a minority of listeners today). I have opted for an eclectic and ad-hoc analytical approach in an attempt to create an analytical adventure for various types of analytically-oriented readers.

³ Cited in Brown (2010, 11). In the original: "Es ist bey dem Fantasiren eine Schönheit, wenn man sich stellet, durch eine förmliche Schlußcadenz in eine andere Tonart auszuweichen, und hernach eine andere Wendung nimmt. Diese, und andere vernünftige Betrügereyen machen eine Fantasie gut: allein sie müssen nicht immer vorkommen, damit das Natürliche nicht ganz und gar darbey verstecket werde." (Bach 1762, 330).

Of course, we might nowadays think about such harmonic relations as based in culture, not nature. In any case, Bach's composition maintains a balance between surprises and returns to convention not only in the tonal domain, but also in those of meter and form.



Example 1. Bach's model fantasy outline (1762, 341).

Example 2 is a harmonic reduction (not to metric scale) of mm. 1–26 of the first movement of the symphony, summarizing the main tonal events in this excerpt. As we can see, after a I-vi-IV opening that clearly projects the home key of D major, mm. 19–20 unexpectedly shift to A minor (key of v), mm. 21–22 tonicize B minor (key of vi) while mm. 23–26 tonicize E minor, which ends up serving as ii6 in the home key, D major. One might therefore think about mm. 19–23 as a parenthetical, ambiguous insert into the clear opening, which disrupts a 5–6 contrapuntal motion

above $\hat{4}$, from IV into ii6.

The image shows a harmonic reduction of measures 19-26 from C. P. E. Bach's Symphony in D major, Wq 183/1. The music is in D major (two sharps) and common time. The reduction is presented in two systems of staves. The first system covers measures 19 and 20, and the second system covers measures 21, 22, 23, and 24-26. Chords are represented by stacked notes with stems, and fingerings are indicated by numbers 4, 5, 6, 7, and 7b. The bass line is shown in the lower staff of each system.

Example 2. Harmonic reduction (not to scale) of C. P. E. Bach, Symphony in D major, Wq 183/1, mm. 1–26.

The stark shift of mm. 19–20 is unexpected, yet it has a decisive tonal implication: the succession of a dim7 sonority followed by a minor 6/4 sonority a semitone above it unambiguously implies in eighteenth-century usage that we have moved to the key of A minor or minor v; the following dim7 followed by root position minor triad a semitone above imply a shift to B minor, assisting us in tonal *position finding* based on eighteenth-century usage, not on some abstract properties (cf. Browne 1981): though we might think of diminished seventh chords as multi-valent vii⁷ chords, their usage in the period often implied that their bass note was $\hat{\#4}$ in context.⁴ Bach’s fantasy-like harmonic feints fail

⁴ As Byros (2012, 2022) elegantly shows, the perception of tonality is influenced by musical usage and schemata. Among its many (meta)-theoretical concerns, Byros’s (2022) study on “Elegant Tones and Fantastical Progressions” tracks the

to materialize with a formal cadence and we are led back to the home key through an E minor sonority in first inversion, which ends up functioning as a ii6 within the home key. Following that chord, the music re-orient us towards the home key through V4/2–I6 resolutions in mm. 27–30, followed by a conventional formal event to be discussed later—a Prinner (Gjerdingen 2007) leading to a HC in the home key or *Quintabsatz* in the home key in neo-Kochian terms (Burstein 2020).⁵ Example 3 presents a harmonic reduction omitting the tonal deception, demonstrating what a more conventional course of tonal events might have been.

Bach's fantasy-like deception may be a subtle polemic with Kirnberger's views on key changes: a paragraph added to the revised 1797 version of Bach's *Versuch*, argues that one may shift quickly as well as slowly to different keys in both improvisation and composition, which is at odds

embedding of diminished seventh chords in figured-bass manuals. Rather than being open to enharmonic reinterpretation in every which way, diminished seventh chords in the long eighteenth century were embedded within specific patterns of resolution with specific tonal implications. According to Byros's figure 27.10, when starting on a dim7 sonority, proceeding a semitone up in the bass, and leading to a min 6/4 sonority, the scale-degree identity of the dim7 sonority's bass is ^#4 in all cases (probability of 1); when starting on a dim7, proceeding a semitone up in the bass, and leading to a root-position minor triad, the scale degree identity of the diminished seventh chord's bass is ^7 in all cases. These are also, respectively, the two most frequent resolutions in a corpus of dim7 chords derived from Bach (1752/1763) and Albrechtsberger (1793–c. 1807), strengthening the connection to practices of improvisation. Though Byros has theoretical misgivings about such a bottom-up understanding, his data suggest that we can unambiguously infer a tonal context from Bach's two-chord successions in mm. 19–20 (=a minor) and 21–22 (=b minor).

⁵ As Burstein (2020) stresses, Koch's terms such as *Quintabsatz* are not synonymous with "HC" or other modern-day cadence labels: these points of formal punctuation can be realized in a variety of ways, some of which appear non-cadential to present-day eyes. In this particular piece (see Example 12d below), all resting points are realized in ways that appear cadential when viewed through present-day cadential terminology.

with Kirnberger's more cautious approach to key changes (Ferris 2020, esp. 72–73).⁶ As Ferris stresses, Bach's addition to the free-fantasy chapter is a rare occasion in which the composer directly engaged in theoretical polemic. I will return below to the possibility that Bach's piece is a coded commentary on Kirnberger's emerging theories of meter. For now, suffice to say that the tonal domain is disrupted in a surprising fashion.

The image displays two systems of musical notation, likely piano reductions of a larger work. The first system consists of two staves. The upper staff contains a series of chords in D major, while the lower staff contains single notes with fingerings: 5, 4+, 6, 4+, 6. The second system is labeled 'Prinner' and 'Quintabsatz'. It also has two staves. The upper staff shows chords with fingerings 6, 5, 4, 3, and 2. The lower staff shows notes with fingerings 4, 3, 2, 1, and 5. The key signature for both systems is D major (two sharps).

Example 3. Reductive analysis of mm. 1–34 (not to scale), omitting the tonal deception.

It may not be a coincidence that the symphony is in the key of D major, like Bach's model fantasy in his treatise. In addition, both pieces are based on an opening bass outline of (disrupted) D-B-G-F# or D-B-F#-G. If such relations seem tenuous, then the specific tonal manipulations discussed by

⁶ In Kirnberger's terms (1982 [1771], 140), a modulation to minor v represents the first level of distant modulations (orig. "erster Grad entfernter Ausweichungen," 1771, 122.).

Bach leave little doubt that the opening of the symphony translates aspects of the keyboard fantasy into the symphonic medium.

2. *Rational Metric Deceptions*

a. *An Implicit Theoretical Commentary?*

Bach's tonal deception—something that he had described explicitly—appears in close proximity to a metric deception, a meter-finding problem (Mirka 2009): the opening of the piece superimposes a syncopated pedal point against chordal arpeggiations. Though the eighth-note subdivisions clearly establish half notes as the perceived tactus of this passage, the opening is highly ambiguous as to whether two or three half notes represent the true perceived meter. Example 4 notates the opening without beaming or bar lines, reflecting the perceived ambiguity: the procrustean bed of music notation and bar lines obscures from our view the richness of this passage for audience members who are not engaged in the highly unusual activity of listening along with a score (i.e., an activity common among music theorists but marginal in human musical experience more broadly). I will unpack below at length the hearings of the passage “in 2” or “in 3” and the factors supporting either hearing.⁷ At present, Example 4 can give readers an opportunity to find a recording of the piece, avoid looking at a score, and experience this meter finding game.

By referring to present-day notions of tactus (Lerdahl & Jackendoff 1983), I am skirting complex historical questions involving notations and conceptions of meter such as whether the common-time time signature represents 4/4 or 2/2: to mention just one factor possibly supporting

⁷ This, of course, is similar to the presentation of the surface of Mozart's G-minor Symphony (K. 550) opening in Lerdahl and Jackendoff (1983, 74); see also Mirka's (2009, 49) survey of Koch's discussion of metric notation. When experimenting informally with a recording, a room full of music theorists was unsure about how to conduct half notes in the opening passage of the symphony, though they had no issue finding the half-note tactus itself.

2/2, the formal punctuation points (discussed below in Section 3) fall on beginnings of notated measures. Whatever the case, the opening of the piece poses a dilemma regarding whether 2 or 3 half notes are to be grouped together in our (presentist) mind's ear.



Example 4. Opening of Wq. 183/1, mvt. 1, without barlines.

Though I skirt certain historical conceptions of meter that would have complicated the present discussion further, I will examine the extent to which Bach's piece draws on metaphors of Kirnberger's theories of meter, which emerged around the time of the composition. Of course, arguments about authorial intent—especially those communicated through music—are risky.⁸ At the same time, the date of the composition along with the emergence of new insights on pulsations in metric theory does not seem coincidental. The two musicians belonged to the same milieu, which makes such connections seem plausible. According to Clark (1997, 17fn3), a letter from Bach to Johann Philipp Kirnberger dated July 21st, 1769, which mentions the latter's composition treatise, may be an indication that Bach was in possession of a draft of Kirnberger's *Die Kunst des reinen*

⁸ For an entry point into discussions of authorial intent, see Haimo (1996).

Satzes, whose first part was published in 1771: Bach writes that Kirnberger is “receiving herewith your composition manual in a nutshell.”⁹ The letter itself mainly addresses the two musicians’ efforts to publish J. S. Bach’s chorales and discusses logistical matters. According to the collective edition of C. P. E. Bach’s works, the composer rehearsed all four symphonies of Wq 183 in August of 1776; he may have composed the first two in fall 1775 and the latter two in spring 1776.¹⁰ In other words, even if Bach could not read the discussions of rhythm and meter in Volume 2, Part 1 of Kirnberger’s (1776) *Art of Strict Musical Composition* (1982 [1776]) prior to composing the first two symphonies of Wq. 183 in (presumably) 1775, he would have been able to encounter such ideas about pulsations in Sulzer’s encyclopedia or through personal discussions. Kirnberger and Schulz’s metric metaphors in their article on rhythm in Sulzer’s encyclopedia were first included in volume two of the original edition, published in 1774. In Kirnberger and Schulz’s vivid language, an artisan striking repeatedly, such as a cooper making a barrel, imposes binary or ternary organization on a series of otherwise undifferentiated pulses (see Example 5). As Mirka surveys (2009, e.g., 13–14), the idea that regularity on two levels—a pulsation level and a slower one—is crucial for establishing meter, was foundational to the development of both late eighteenth-century and late twentieth-century metric theories. Kirnberger and Schulz write:

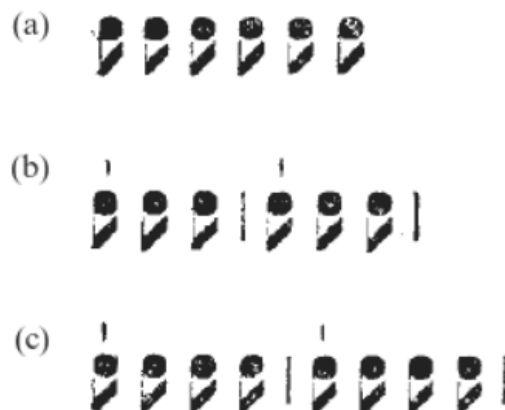
The cooper who drives a hoop [onto a barrel], [or] the coppersmith who hammers a kettle soon takes it into his head to perform his beats not singly in a completely identical way [as in Example 2/11a]; [rather] he will soon beat them [as in Examples 2.11b or 2.11c] in order to slightly differentiate the strength or the pitch [*Ton*] of the three or four beats going on one

⁹ This is letter #22 in Clark’s numbering (1997, 17–18). Frustratingly, Suchalla’s edition (1994, 1: 177–179, document 75) has a fragmentary version of this letter, which does not include this key phrase—hence I was unable to track the German original that underlies Clark’s translation.

¹⁰ Kidger (2005, vii).

measure, so that the division of groups may become perceptible to the ear.” (Mirka’s translation, 2009, 47).¹¹

Example 2.11. Kirnberger and Schulz, “Rhythmus,” 97.



Example 5. Mirka (2009, 47, example 2.11), from Kirnberger and Schulz (1794, 97) [cf. 1774, 980].

Bach’s opening musical idea (Example 4) bears some similarity to Kirnberger and Schulz’s example: in the lower layer, a series of 6 attack points is involved in a metrically ambiguous passage, though the ambiguity in Bach’s case is not about groups of eighth-note pulses but about the number of half-note units within a perceived measure. Within the six strokes, the fourth one is highlighted for our

¹¹ In the original: “Der Faßbinder, oder Böttcher, der einen Reifen antreibt, der Kupferschmied, der einen Kessel hämmert, fällt gar bald darauf, seine Schläge nicht einzeln in völliger Gleichheit so zu thun [Example 2.10a] u. s. f. er wird bald so schlagen: [Example 2.10b] u. s. f. oder so: [Example 2.10c] u. s. f. um die Stärke oder den Ton der drey, oder vier auf einen Takt gehenden Schlägen etwas abzuändern, damit die Eintheilung in Glieder dem Ohr merklich werde.” (Kirnberger and Schulz 1794, 97, cited in Mirka 2009, 47). In the second volume of the first edition, this quotation and the notations cited here as Example 5 (Mirka’s example 2.11) are at Kirnberger and Schulz (1774, 980). This is the edition that would have been available to Bach while working on the symphony. See also the discussion of subjective rhythmization in London (2012, 13–15).

attention as a melodic peak through its highest pitch, which is crucial for the meter-finding game of Bach's opening.

A Metaphor from Kirnberger's *Art of Strict Musical Composition* also seems pertinent:

A melody that just flows along without accents resembles a continuous motion, like that created when a body falls or is thrown through the air; but an accented melody is similar to a motion divided into steps or to walking. Just as walking receives its particular character from the type as well as the speed of the steps, melody receives its character and expression in quite a similar way. (1982, 382)¹²

Bach's up-and-down gestures in Wq. 183/1 resonate with Kirnberger's metaphors: for instance, mm. 67–68 (Example 16 below) display a continuous up and down motion (whose parallelism conforms to the level of an entire measure); mm. 24–26 (Example 10 below) contain a free fall through pitch space as well as a bounce-back effect. This free fall would not have been metrically clear if it were not for the effect of the zig-zaggy alternation as in “steps.” Moreover, the turning point on the downbeat of m. 26 reinforces the meter.

Aside from these metaphors, Kirnberger (1982 [1776], 394) explicitly writes about a C. P. E. Bach symphony in 3/2 that presents an unusual subdivision into continuous thirty-second notes. The translators' note identifies this as the symphony Wq. 179. Kirnberger writes:

3/2 meter is used very often, especially in church pieces, because of the ponderous and slow performance indicated by its note values. In the chamber style, sixteenth notes can also be used in 3/2 meter; C. P. E. Bach has even begun a symphony in this meter with many thirty-second notes in a row. [A translators' note here identifies this as Wq. 179 and comments that the subdivision is actually to sixteenth notes]. With such note values, the three beats of this

¹² German original: “Der unaccentuirte blos strömende Gesang gleichet einer durchaus steten Bewegung, wie die ist, durch welche ein Körper durch die Luft fällt, oder geworfen wird; der accentuirte Gesang aber hat Aehnlichkeit mit einer in Schritte abgetheilten Bewegung, oder des Ganges. Wie nun der Gang, noch außer dem langsamen und geschwinden, noch durch die Art der Schritte seinen bestimmten Charakter bekommt, so geschieht es auf eine ganz ähnliche Weise, daß auch der Gesang seinen Charakter und Ausdruck erhält (1776, 114).

meter must be indicated most clearly in the other voices; otherwise the melody would remain fuzzy and incomprehensible to the listener.¹³

Symphony in E-flat Major

Wq 179

Prestissimo

Corno I, II
in Eb

Oboe I, II

Violino I

Violino II

Viola

Basso

Example 6a. Symphony in Eb major, Wq. 179, movement 1, mm. 1–2.

¹³ German original: “Der Dreyzweyteltackt ist wegen des schweren und langsamen Vortrags, den seine Notengattungen bezeichnen, zumal in Kirchenstücken, von dem vielfältigen Gebrauch. In diesem Styl sind Viertel, höchstens Achtel, seine geschwindesten Notengattungen. Im Cammerstyle können auch wol Sechszehntel in dem 3/2 Tackt angebracht werden, ja hr. C. P. E. Bach hat sogar eine Sinfonie in dieser Tackart mit vielen nach einander folgenden Zweyunddreyßigtheilen angefangen. Bey solchen Notengattungen müßen die drey Zeiten dieser Tackart in den übrigen Stimmen aufs deutlichste marquirt werden, ohnedem bleibet der Gesang für den Zuhörer dunkel und unverständlich.” (1776, 127)

Example 6b shows measures 26 and 27 of a musical movement. The score is written for five staves. The first two staves are vocal parts (Soprano and Alto) in treble clef, and the last three staves are piano accompaniment (Right Hand, Left Hand, and Bass) in bass clef. The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). Measure 26 begins with a soprano line starting on G4, followed by an alto line on F4. The piano accompaniment features a complex rhythmic pattern with sixteenth and thirty-second notes. Measure 27 continues the vocal lines and the piano accompaniment, with a fermata over the final notes of both vocal parts.

Example 6b. MM. 26–27 of the same movement

Example 6c shows measures 21–25 of the same movement. The score is in G major (one sharp) and 3/2 time. It features five staves: two for violins, two for violas, and a basso continuo. Measures 21–25 show complex rhythmic patterns with trills, slurs, and dynamic markings (p, f, unis.). The basso continuo line includes figured bass notation: 6, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 6, 4, 5.

Example 6c. MM. 21–25 of the same movement.

A brief look at the earlier symphony Wq. 179 (1757) is instructive: mm. 1–2 (Example 6a) and their recasting in mm. 26–27 (Example 6b) show some of Bach’s metric play in this earlier work. In m. 1, the up-and-down parallel gestures of the first violins subdivide the measure into two dotted half notes, obscuring the notated meter at the outset (before the meter has been fully established in our perception); in m. 26, in contrast, the earlier change of direction better reflects the notated meter. M. 2 and its closer repetition in m. 27 supports the notated 3/2 through surface gestures, including continuous up-and-down gestures that create a clear parallelism of groupings congruent with the meter—something that, as we will see, is echoed in Wq. 183 (for instance, see Example 16 below).

Note that in mm. 21–24 of the same movement from Wq. 179 (Example 6c), the bowings obscure the melodic groupings that conform to the notated meter. Kirnberger focuses on the complex interactions of meter, tempo, character, and possible subdivisions, yet his discussion raises the possibility that Bach’s earlier symphony is at least somewhat “fuzzy and incomprehensible” in its meter, representing an unusually high level of subdivisions in 3/2. As we will see in Section 3, Wq. 183/1’s drive towards several punctuation points within the exposition is done with a compositional constraint, according to which there is a lowest-available subdivision available at each point (quarter notes, eighth notes, or sixteenth notes). While Kirnberger reacts to the unusually small subdivisions in Wq. 179, it is possible that Wq. 183/1 represents Bach’s playful reaction to Kirnberger’s prescriptions regarding the subdivisions appropriate for various meters.

Wq. 179 and Wq. 183/1 share several design features, which suggests that the composer revisited certain ideas in the later symphony: both symphonies have tonally open movements connecting to the following movement; both first movements lack an exposition repeat and have a final form-defining cadence of the exposition elided into to the development section; finally, both pieces have some play on up-and-down gestures whose parallelism conforms to (or deviates from) the notated meter. In other words, it seems likely that Bach recycled compositional ideas between the two pieces, even if Wq. 183/1 is quite a bit more adventurous.

To summarize this survey, let us take stock of the potential evidence for a relation between Bach’s Wq. 183/1 and Kirnberger’s emerging notions of meter and broader theorizing:

- 1) Bach and Kirnberger belonged to the same musical-intellectual milieu;
- 2) It is possible that Kirnberger circulated his composition treatise to Bach before its publication (or otherwise exchanged ideas with him);

- 3) Even if the discussion of meter in *The Art of Strict Musical Composition* was unavailable to Bach while working on Wq. 183, he would have been able to read Kirnberger and Schulz's encyclopedia article;
- 4) Bach explicitly wrote about rational tonal deceptions in his keyboard treatise; Wq. 183/1 utilizes such tonal deceptions in close proximity to a metric deception;
- 5) Bach's tonal deception is at odds with Kirnberger's more cautious approach to key changes, connecting to a rare area in which Bach engaged in an overt polemic with Kirnberger (Ferris 2020);
- 6) Kirnberger reacted to the earlier Wq. 179 in *The Art of Strict Musical Composition*: Wq. 183/1 reuses some of the same tricks as Wq. 179 yet goes further in its gestural, tonal, and metric play;
- 7) In addition, as I will discuss below, a portion of Bach's exposition resembles a counterpoint exercise and playfully engages Kirnberger's notions of essential vs. nonessential dissonance as well as his views on the strict and galant styles;
- 8) Finally, and most speculatively, Bach's symphony mirrors specific metaphors used by Kirnberger (or Kirnberger and Schulz) regarding repeated artisanal strokes and continuous vs. divided motion of a body through space.

Having speculated about the possibility that the symphony is an implicit commentary on Kirnberger's theories, especially his emerging conception of meter, I will now resume the analytical thread where I had left it—shifting from a view of the tonal disruption to a discussion of the metrically ambiguous opening.

b. *Unpacking a Meter-Finding Problem*

Let us now examine the metric ambiguity associated with Bach's opening hammer strokes. Example 7 presents the musical surface of the opening without beams and barlines, adding arrows to indicate

how the lower layer of pulsations starts to create metric projections in a meter-finding game (Mirka 2009).



Example 7. Unbarred, un-beamed version of the opening of C. P. E. Bach, Symphony Wq. 183/1, mvt. 1.

Bach's gestures—perhaps akin to artisanal hammer strokes—create *melodic accents* based on the “sheer differences between ‘higher/lower’ tones” (Mirka 2009, 38). As Mirka observes, this is a usage of pitch as a *statistical* rather than *syntactical* parameter in Meyer's (1989, 1998) terms.¹⁴ While I will not provide a Mirka-style projective analysis in this article, arrows in Example 7 highlight how—once the lower layer of motion in eighth note enters—both quarter notes and half notes are established clearly to perception. The “onset” of motion in eighth notes is, in fact, the third attack point of the upper D5, which—in combination with the lower pulsations entering an eighth note

¹⁴ See also the comments in Mirka (2009, 45–46) and her example 2.9 (from Kirnberger and Schulz 1794, 101), regarding the affinity between pitch height and dynamic accents. In the first edition of Sulzer's encyclopedia, this is at Kirnberger and Schulz (1774, 983).

later—starts this motion. What remains ambiguous is whether half notes are to be grouped into twos or threes: should we attend to groups of two or three half notes?

Example 8a presents a reduction of mm. 1–7 in their original barring, whereas Example 8b re-bars the music in 3/2. Part of the problem here, of course, is that the subdivision into eighth notes (as well as quarter notes) is not articulated at the outset of the piece.¹⁵ Again, though I do not mirror Mirka's projective analysis or graphics literally, one could paraphrase my observations about preference factors for the notated meter vs. 3/2 in terms of real-time projections (and, indeed, these preference factors are responsible for the ambiguity in perceived meter at the opening of this piece).

(onset of eighth notes)

1

(=V4/2 of IV)

5

IV (6-----5)

V

3

Example 8a. C. P. E. Bach, Symphony Wq 183/1/i, mm. 1–7, reduction of the orchestral score into two staves.

¹⁵ Compare this to Mirka's (2009, 35) observations about her initial Haydn example for meter finding, example 2.1 (*Ibid.*, 34), the opening of Haydn's Quartet Op. 50, no. 6, mvt. 1.

What factors support the notated meter? Our tendency to hear an initial accent and to impose binary regularity favor the notated meter from the outset in mm. 1–2, though the surface gives us few attack points to work with. One might experience the upwards arpeggio of the lower strings as an upbeat into the downbeats of the melodically accented highpoints on the downbeats of m. 3 and m. 4, creating strong parallelism.¹⁶ In addition, the most salient chord change in this passage is the one involving the resolution to a subdominant chord on the downbeat of m. 6, marking that timepoint for our attention.¹⁷ The transformation of the tonic chord into a V4/2 of IV is more problematic for present purposes: should we hear a chord change on the fourth beat of notated m. 4? Should we pay attention to the (relatively) novel and salient C4 in the middle of m. 5? Under the notated meter, this is a point of incongruence, since the peak of m. 5's wave falls in its middle. Finally, the change to unison octaves on the downbeat of m. 7 supports the notated meter.

Though these are compelling factors in favor of the meter as notated, there are also some challenges: in particular, the (perceived) onset of eighth-note motion in the middle of m. 2 is incongruent with the meter. This suggests retrospectively interpreting the opening whole→half note pattern of the upper layer as a measure in 3/2. In addition, the indirect metric dissonances (in Krebs's 1999 terms) in the upper layer are disorienting: from m. 3, half notes are shifted by a quarter note, while quarter notes (in mm. 5–6) are displaced by eighth notes. This deprives the downbeats of

¹⁶ Mirka (2009, 39 table 2.1) lists these factors as “initial accent” and “binary regularity” (equivalent to Lerdahl and Jackendoff's 1983 MPR 2, “strong beat early,” and MPR 10, “binary regularity”). Lerdahl and Jackendoff's (1983) parallelism rule is MPR1.

¹⁷ As Temperley (2008, 318) observes, “not all harmonic changes are equal”: The root-preserving harmonic change from I to V⁷/IV is not as strong as the change to a IV chord in Bach's m. 6. As Mirka (2009, 39, 50–52) surveys, harmonic change is a most powerful preference factor and it is de facto subsumed under Lerdahl and Jackendoff's MPR5f and MPR8.

mm. 3–6 of upper-layer attack points that might have clarified the notated meter (note, too, that the downbeat of m. 5 has no attack point in either layer).

The re-barréd Example 8b represents the meter as it may be heard initially. There are some attractive aspects to this reading, which I find more compelling subjectively.¹⁸ In the 3/2 hearing, the downbeat of re-barréd m. 2 is the onset of (perceived) motion in eighth notes. Subsequently, the downbeats of re-notated m. 3 and m. 4 coincide with the melodic accent of the highpoints, clarifying the sense of 3/2. The downbeat of re-barréd m. 5 is strongly emphasized through the unison gesture.

(onset of eighth notes)

mf

mf

(superfluous beat)

(main chord change to IV)

Example 8b. Re-barring of Example 8a. The final half-note beat of m. 5 does not exist in the original.

¹⁸ Since this piece is somewhat obscure, it has provided me interesting opportunities for experiential conducting activities with students and professional colleagues in presentations or classes, with the task being to conduct the half-note tactus “in 2” or “in 3”: the ambiguity was visceral to the attendees on all such occasions.

To be sure, the first arpeggiated peak, in re-notated m. 2, beat 2, is incongruent with the 3/2 hearing. Another drawback of this interpretation is the fact that re-barred m. 5 corresponds to original m. 7, which—in the actual score—includes only two half-note beats. In performance, however, there might be a tendency to extend this in a hesitant fashion—as in Andrew Manze’s delightful recording (cf. also Mirka 2009, esp. 119).¹⁹ The most salient chord change in the passage falls on the second half note of re-barred m. 4 in this hearing, again, weakening the 3/2 hearing and favoring the notated meter. Whatever its drawbacks, Example 8b outlines a plausible real-time hearing of this unusual opening.

The second, B-minor wave of arpeggios, is even more strongly suggestive of 3/2, since it is based entirely in a single sonority, vi, without any chord changes that might serve as metric cues—see the original notation in Example 9a and a re-barred version in Example 9b.

¹⁹ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2PJ6TiWIw08>, accessed Dec. 26, 2024. Of course, for an audience member in view of the conductor’s gestures, visual cues may provide clarity that is absent in an audio recording.

Example 9a. Mvt. 1, mm. 8–14, author's reduction.

Example 9b. Re-barring of Example 9a in 3/2.

Moreover, successively rising highpoints on D4 and F#4 emerge on the downbeats of re-barréd m. 10 and m. 11 (Example 9b), creating melodic accents and parallelism among the second and third sub-waves of this arpeggio. Thus, the second, b-minor triad, wave supports 3/2 more strongly than

the first wave. The third and final wave (Example 10), on a IV sonority in mm. 15–18, is truncated, deviating from the pre-established pattern and leading to the surprising tutti texture of m. 19. One of the most disorienting things about the opening arpeggiated waves is the lack of consistent parallelism between the three-upbeat-stroke gestures and the melodic peaks to which they lead. The sub-waves of ups and downs do not consistently support either a 2/2-like or 3/2-like grouping, and if we try to impose either on the surface, something will always remain incongruent and unsettling.

The events of m. 19 are remarkable (see Example 10): finally, the notated meter—with its various layers—is clearly revealed to the mind’s ear. A powerful preference factor, chord changes, reinforces each downbeat from m. 19 to m. 24. Eighth-note pulsations continue, while various instruments highlight other subdivisions with simultaneous or *direct* displacement dissonances (after Krebs 1999): quarter-notes offset by an eighth note in the first violins (D2+1), as well as half notes offset by quarter notes in the flutes and oboes (D4+2, with 1=eighth note, see Example 10). Thus, displacements that were heard successively (or *indirectly*) at the outset are now sounded simultaneously in a tonally unsettling yet metrically clear tutti. These displaced layers interact with unsyncopated half notes in the horns as well as unsyncopated whole notes in the continuo instruments. Thus, mm. 19–23 render the notated meter crystal clear, though with a piling up of displacement dissonances differentiated through timbre.²⁰

The home-key ii⁶ of mm. 24–26 (see Example 10) represents not only the cessation of harmonic deception, but also clarifies the metric grid through melodic accents and parallelism between motions in pitch space (and also in the space of a triad): each quarter note is subdivided into a high-low pattern, while a two-measure unit emerges in mm. 24–25 and contrasted with a 1-

²⁰ This timbral differentiation is brought out clearly in a recording by the WDR symphony conducted by Andrea Marcon (accessed 12/26/2024): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bVhV-Qwlc5Y>

measure gesture in m. 26. Now no displacement dissonances or wrinkles are left: the zig-zaggy pattern projects quarter notes clearly; the bouncing back up of a metaphoric object in space is congruent with the notated meter.

Thus, we can narrate the events of the first 26 measures as follows: the symphony starts with a meter-finding problem through waves of arpeggiations translating the rhetoric of a keyboard fantasy to the symphonic medium; a tutti entrance solves the metric problem while introducing harmonic fantasy-like deceptions. In this way, the piece poses some compositional and generic problems to be solved later: how can the fantasy-like, hesitant (but in-tempo) arpeggiations find their place in a more orderly symphonic exposition? How would we know that we have entered the script of a sonata exposition and have decisively quit the generic allusions to the keyboard fantasy of the opening?²¹ As I will demonstrate in the upcoming sections, Bach takes elements that were initially ambiguous or fantasy-like and embeds them in conventional positions in the remainder of the exposition. Thus, he reinterprets such “problematic” elements as conventional elements of the mold of a galant exposition.

²¹ The tonally open ending of the first two movements and the unusual tonal relation of the inner movement (key of bII) also give this symphony a fantasy-like character. Such factors, however, are not quite as disorienting as the first movement’s opening.

15

ff

D4+2

15

ff

ff

D2+1

15

ff

ff

ff

15

ff

7 6
5 4

ff

Example 10. Symphony Wq. 183/1, mvt. 1, mm. 15–26 (continued overleaf)

21

D4+2

a2

D2+1

p

pp

p

p

p

21

7
5

5

4

6

Example 10 (continued)

27

f

27

f

(single-note idea)

f

27

f

f

f

f

27

f

6 — 2

6 —

6 — 2

6 —

27

f

Example 11. Symphony Wq. 183/1, mm. 27–34 (continued overleaf)

31

(sus. chain)

Prinner

6 5 4 3 2

Quintabsatz

31

9 6 7 5 —

9 6 7 — 9 7 — 7 5 5

4 3 7 1 5

unis.

Example 11 (continued)

3. *Rational Formal Deception*

As the opening problems subside, it becomes clear that we have now entered the realm of a *galant exposition* (Burstein 2020). After dominant-tonic resolutions in mm. 27–30 (Example 11), the onset of the home-key Prinner schema in m. 31 is a particularly orienting cue for our position in the exposition’s journey, yet one that arrives unusually late. A home-key Prinner riposte is a hallmark of the galant style (Gjerdingen (2007): this schema is conventional and is very often a “riposte” to an opening idea, be it an interopus schema or a piece-specific opening gambit. In this particular case, the schema signals the shift from the fantasy-like opening into a conventional galant-exposition course of events: this shift is strongly supported through the subsequent chain of events, in which the music forges its way towards conventional cadential points of articulation.

I follow here Burstein’s (2020) neo-Kochian terms (and adapt his graphic representation) for presenting the punctuation form of galant expositions. My motivation in understanding the punctuation sequence has less to do with the fact that it was explicitly described in the period and more with the fact that these were the formal conventions with which Bach worked, rather than with those of the (later) high-classical exposition. To be sure, we might be more familiar with high-classical expositions both through musical exposure and through influential theoretical descriptions (Caplin 1998; Hepokoski and Darcy 2006), yet this later formal mold is misleading when dealing with galant-style expositions.

Example 12a shows the basic punctuation sequence; Example 12b shows a possible sequence without a *Grundabsatz*, which is echoed in Bach’s compositional choices; Example 12c shows a sequence with two *Quintabsätze* in the key of V, with a succession of a more active one leading to a point of articulation followed by a more lyrical one, creating variety even as the exposition progresses twice towards the “same” punctuation point in the sequence. As we can glean from Example 12d, Bach’s exposition both omits the *Grundabsatz* and repeats its motion towards a

Quintabsatz in the key of V. As Burstein emphasizes, certain things about the punctuation outline are disorienting to our high-classical-biased minds:²²

- 1) Galant expositions work their way towards several punctuation points, which may or may not overlap with present-day definitions of cadences or expectations about themes and their contrasting characters;
- 2) There is no expectation for a big mid-exposition cadence akin to Hepokoski and Darcy's (2006) MC; there is also nothing unusual (or particularly marked for our attention) about a piece with two half-cadential breaks.²³
- 3) Areas of the exposition are not defined as containers but rather based on the point of cadential (or other) articulation towards which they lead;
- 4) Though we expect thematic contrast in the secondary key area with a more lyrical theme, this was actually an optional element that would have been construed as an "insert" in the period.²⁴

Taking these issues in turn as they apply to Bach's exposition, we can make the following observations:

- 1) All of the punctuation points in Example 12d manifest as cadence points that would be recognized as such in modern-day terminology (HC in the home key, two HCs in the key of V, and an elided PAC in the key of V);
- 2) The *Quintabsatz* of m. 34 (see also Example 11) has the most MC-like features (energizing towards it, a literal gap after it, and a significant textural drop after it), yet the second

²² For instance, see the summary of Burstein (2020, 8–9).

²³ Burstein dedicates his Chapter 11 to expositions with two half-cadential breaks.

²⁴ See Burstein's (2020, 94–95) discussion of Galeazzi's *Passo di mezzo*.

Quintabsatz in V of m. 56 might be more decisive and is followed by the drive towards ultimate cadential closure for the exposition; the multiplicity of cadence points should not be particularly marked for our analytical attention but rather represents earlier compositional practices;²⁵

- 3) If anything is “redundant” about Bach’s form as represented in 12d it is not the second *Quintabsatz* in V, but rather the cantabile materials of mm. 35–48 (see Example 14), which can be considered an insert. Note that the piece could have progressed through the punctuation sequence even without one of the *Quintabsätze* in V and it is the slower, cantabile one in mm. 35–48 that impedes its progress. Nevertheless, in the compositional game of this particular piece, the materials leading up to these punctuation points provide opportunities for adapting the opening fantasy-like materials and for solving the ambiguities and problems that they pose.

<i>Grundabsatz</i>	<i>Quintabsatz</i>	<i>Quintabsatz</i> in V	<i>Schlußsatz</i>
..... → I	 → V	 → V/V	 → <i>Cadenz</i> in V

Example 12a, after Burstein (2020, 73, example 4.5). Standard punctuation succession for a galant exposition.

²⁵ For instance, see Burstein’s observation (2020, 272n21) that “it would be too restrictive and tautological to argue that the first half-cadential break that precedes a new-key theme must by definition be regarded as the medial caesura. If the concepts of the medial caesura and post-medial caesura are to have implications for interpretation and performance, some features must suggest that the medial caesura proper could be fairly portrayed as having greater formal weight ...” Perhaps the fact that the paired *Quintabsätze* in V follow the order “cantabile” then more active and “*rauschend*” can be viewed as a deviation from the convention of starting with a more active *Quintabsatz* and moving to a more cantabile one (see Burstein 2020, 61–63 and the analysis of Mariana Martines’s Sonata no. 3 there: such a pairing does not necessarily correspond to what we would now label as transition and secondary theme, *Ibid.*, 86). In any case, the piece under consideration is so unusual that a flipped order of cantabile–*rauschend* seems like a minor detail given its overall adherence to punctuation norms.

<i>Quintabsatz</i>	<i>Quintabsatz</i> in V	<i>Schlußsatz</i>
..... → V	 → V/V	 → <i>Cadenz</i> in V

Example 12b. After Burstein (2020, 75, example 4.8c), punctuation form without a *Grundabsatz*.

<i>Grundabsatz</i>	<i>Quintabsatz</i>	<i>Quintabsatz</i> in V (<i>rauschend</i>)	<i>Quintabsatz</i> in V (<i>cantabile</i>)	<i>Schlußsatz</i>
..... → I	 → V	 → V/V	 → V/V	... → <i>Cadenz</i> in V

Example 12c. After Burstein (2020, 75, example 4.9b), motion towards *Quintabsatz* is repeated twice with different characters

	<i>Quintabsatz</i> (mm. 1–34)	<i>Quintabsatz</i> in V cantabile, reduced texture (mm. 35– 48)	<i>Quintabsatz</i> in V, <i>Rauschend</i> (mm. 49–56)	<i>Schlußsatz</i> (mm. 57–72)
	 → V	 → V/V	 → V/V	 <i>Cad.</i> in V (elided)
Smallest note value	1–26 27–34 8th 16th	Quarter note	16th	16th

Example 12d. Parsing Bach’s exposition in relation to the punctuation script.

Overall, the story of Example 12a–12d is one of a musical work conforming to conventions of its time. How then can we explain the shock value of the home-ley Prinner of m. 31? I have explored above the notion that this “riposte” to an opening arrives too late, or, viewed differently, puts the piece back in its tracks. This schema often leads to a galant punctuation point, be it a *Grundabsatz* ending on its $\wedge^3$ or a home-key *Quintabsatz* with an added descent to $\wedge^2$: by reaching the latter resting point, it retroactively clarifies that the piece so far had been working towards a home-key *Quintabsatz* (see Burstein 2020, 44–45).²⁶ In this particular case, the entrance of the Prinner (as a strong cue for position within form) signals that we have now departed from the idiosyncratic, fantasy-like opening and reconnected to a much more conventional course of events within a galant exposition.

²⁶ Cf. Caplin’s (2015, 41) discussion of the respective “syntactical strength” of a Prinner ending on $\wedge^3$ answered by a phrase in which the Prinner continues on to a HC ending on $\wedge^2$. Though Caplin subsumes the Prinner under his form-functional apparatus, his discussion demonstrates the wealth of possibilities associated with this skeletal structure.

The Prinner's rushing towards a conventional punctuation point therefore leads to a conventional formal outline as elucidated in Example 12d. Yet the symphony's stark shift from fantasy to conventional sonata also comes into play through a recasting of former "problem," fantasy elements into more conventional molds. In describing the materials following the *Quintabsatz* of m. 34, I will not proceed in strictly chronological order, but will rather examine transformations of individual compositional ideas.

The punctuation form also interacts with the metric play and play on various levels of subdivision: at each point, there is a lowest-available metric subdivision available for use: this is marked on the bottom row of the table of Example 12d. Each one of the processes of motion towards a resting point is associated with the availability of a lowest-possible subdivision, i.e., eighth note, sixteenth note, or quarter note. The only exception to this rule is the process leading to the initial *Quintabsatz*, which starts out with eighth notes as the lowest possible division and adds in sixteenth notes around the point in which the fantasy becomes a sonata.²⁷ This compositional constraint, akin to a counterpoint exercise, facilitates some of the motivic connections and interplay between the compositional "problems" of the opening fantasy and their resolution in the more sonata-like portion of this exposition.

²⁷ Indeed, Example 12d stresses that the cantabile materials of mm. 35–48 are a kind of "insert" that blunts the momentum towards further punctuation points in the formal script of the galant exposition.

4. *Transforming Ideas*

a) Single-note idea

Bach's compositional choice of a fantasy-like deception in the key of minor v, a minor, was felicitous: this allows the same absolute bass pitches, D#–E, to contribute to conventional punctuations within the galant exposition. The softer materials presented starting in m. 35 (Example 14) contain “touches” upon bass D#–E (m. 41, mm. 43–44), which are then transformed into the first *Quintabsatz* in V. M. 47 attains this punctuation point softly, in a light texture. In this way, the fantasy-like tutti burst is tamed into a reduced texture and also becomes part of the conventional course of events in the galant exposition. But the story of these pitches is not over: they are also integrated into another point of arrival, that is, the second *Quintabsatz* in V of m. 56. The tutti-texture drive towards this repeated point of formal articulation is accompanied by a shift to the parallel minor, along with the embedding of D#–E into Byros's (2012) le-sol-fi-sol schema (not shown as a score example): this creates a more emphatic arrival on these pitches.²⁸ With the le-sol-fi-sol, we have a tutti-forte counterpart to the surprise of m. 19, which is now fitted into the mold of the galant exposition. The le-sol-fi-sol schema also provides us a wider schematic context that was tonally unambiguous at the time (Byros 2012, 291): the tonal shift at the opening was unexpected; the shift to the parallel minor that embeds a le-sol-fi-sol on the way to a *Quintabsatz* in V is more conventional.²⁹ With the risk of committing the grave anachronism of equating the *Quintabsatz* in V with its descendent in the high-classical exposition, V: HC MC, note that the latter cadence point is

²⁸ Note that the recognition of the le-sol-fi-sol schema was responsible both for historical listeners' hearing a clear shift to G minor at the opening of Beethoven's Eroica Symphony as well as to invocations of improvisation, as in the 1807 review by Friedrich Rochlitz cited by Byros (2012, 285).

²⁹ On the association between le-sol-fi-sol and HCs, see Byros (2012, 295–299).

often preceded by a shift to the parallel minor.³⁰ Though words of caution about anachronisms are surely necessary here, the predecessor formal juncture (*Quintabsatz* in V) in galant expositions cited by Burstein (2020) are sometimes preceded by a parallel-minor effect (e.g., those composed by Marpurg, 126, ex. 7.2 and W. A. Mozart, ex. 11.1, 183–4). In any case, the formerly disruptive tonal shift finds a proper place in the galant exposition and is embedded in a conventional schema that suits a switch to the parallel minor (the *le-sol-fi-sol*) and reaches a conventional punctuation point.

Though the materials from m. 35 onwards sound fresh, the piece exhibits an intricate web of compositional ideas that are revisited (Example 14). The second oboe in mm. 35–36 articulates the single-note idea with which the first violins opened the piece: the oboes subsequently enter a chain of 2–3 suspensions that supports the notated meter through the suspensions, which are unambiguously associated with metric stress.³¹ The syncopations of the opening repeated-note idea are translated into the bassoon part, where they are set in relief as local melodic highpoints on weak beats (see asterisks in Example 14): melodic highpoints, often preceded by wide leaps into them, in mm. 37–44 set in relief a variant of the growingly dense opening syncopations of the first violins. This is constrained by the fastest-available pulse in this area. In other words, the bassoon’s active melodic line “translates” through its melodic peaks (or melodic accents) the compositional idea of syncopations from the single-note ideas into a freely floating counter-melody. Example 13 turns the

³⁰ Hepokoski and Darcy (2006, 25) note the possibility of reaching a V: HC MC by way of a “darkened pathway” with a shift to the parallel minor.

³¹ Both the single-note idea and the suspension-chain idea (in a 7-6 guise) are foreshadowed in the oboes and horns in mm. 27–30 and 31–32, respectively. The former idea is also reinforced stereophonically through the first and second violins in alternation in mm. 27–30 (refer back to Example 11).

bassoon's melodic accents into a single-note syncopated line, demonstrating how this ornate and galant contour is in fact a motivic transformation of the single-note idea.



Example 13. Translating the bassoon's melodic accents in mm. 35–44 to a syncopated line playing on the single-note opening idea (in m. 43, the leap down and change of direction were taken to imply an accent on a salient second quarter note).

The relation between the strict counterpoint of the oboes and the bassoon's galant activity brings to mind Kirnberger's discussion of strict counterpoint and the galant style, as well as his distinction between essential and nonessential dissonances: the oboes' strict-style suspensions consistently fall on downbeats; the bassoon's sinuous galant line outlines some dominant seventh chords. Kirnberger recognizes that an essential dissonance may fall not only on a weak beat but sometimes on a strong beat, while a suspension never falls on a weak beat (1982, 97; [1771, 78]). To put it in terms inspired by Klorman (2016), the oboes and the bassoons are having a conversation on this topic of dissonance treatment, in which the bassoon's line defines the terms of the conversation. After all, it is the bassoon—with its more galant and up-to-date perspective—that determines whether a particular suspension is just a suspension or also the seventh of a dominant-seventh chord.

In m. 44 (Example 14), the violins enter with the single-note idea and accelerate to the extent possible with the prevailing constraint of quarter notes as the smallest possible subdivision. In other words, after the bassoon's veiled foreshadowing, the idea is clearly reiterated by the violins. In addition, the E6 highpoint of the flutes in m. 45 foreshadows the violins' syncopation, since it is on the second beat; the subdivided beat 2 of m. 47, which stands out from its surroundings, coincides

with the violins' syncopation. Thus, the interplay of the flutes and violins in mm. 44–48 continues to elaborate on the single-note idea.

As mentioned above, the opening is based upon a D-B-F# bass outline, which it shares with the written-out fantasy in the composer's keyboard treatise. This outline is subtly replicated in mm. 37–40: though the piece is now in the key of V (and making its way to a *Quintabsatz* in V), D and B as bass notes and implied triadic sonorities are set in high relief both as downbeats and in terms of the bassoon's contour; the F# in m. 40 is highlighted for our attention as a resolution of a preceding V6/5 of f# minor. Though embedded in a new context, these events monotonally echo the fantasy-like opening. Thus, an idea formerly associated with fantasy-like ambiguity now finds its place in a

Example 14 (continued)

Example 15. Symphony Wq. 183/1, mvt. 1, mm. 56–62 (continued overleaf)

(Comma) Cadence (Evaded)

Example 15 (continued)

b) Arpeggiated hammer strokes become Fenaroli

Following the darker, second *Quintabsatz* in V of m. 56, Bach uses a conventional galant schema as part of his drive towards a final cadence: a Fenaroli in mm. 56–60 (Example 15) and 63–67 (not shown as a score example). This instantiation of the Fenaroli is a transformation of the six artisanal strokes from the opening, recasting an ambiguous element into the mold of conventional schema within its typical position in the galant exposition. Several surface features correspond particularly well to the schema, beyond the typical outer-voice scale degree patterns: 1) the schema is characterized by its twofold repetition of its scale-degree constellation; 2) the outer-voice scale degrees of the schema are often accompanied by a $\wedge^5$ pedal, here situated prominently in the horns (of mm. 56–60, not repeated in the second instance); 3) Finally, though often associated with secondary key-area materials brought back in the home key (Gjerdingen 2007, 228), the schema is “too processive” (*Ibid.*, 462) when looking for a secondary theme (i.e., anachronistically applying a later sonata model to a galant piece). The mysterious, opening artisanal strokes are thus molded into a commonplace pattern that is given a tuneful galant realization, unlike the opening fantasy-like arpeggiation. In other words, this Fenaroli is a solution to a piece-specific compositional “problem” through a conventional schema: much like the le-sol-fi-sol retro-fitted the fantasy-like outburst into an appropriate cadential function within the galant exposition, the Fenaroli molds the inchoate arpeggios into a typical schema in a conventional position.

The twofold repetition of the schema is also felicitous for compositional problem solving. While the opening three eighth-note strokes had always sounded like an upbeat—which remains the case here—the Fenaroli affords parallelism in congruence with the piece’s notated meter through its characteristic repetitions. This stands in stark contrast with the more challenging search for parallelism among highpoints discussed above while considering the respective merits of perceiving

the opening in terms of two or three half notes. The harmonic framework (in essence a repeated resolution of $V7 \rightarrow I$ in some inversion based on the contrapuntal stacking of the scale-degree strands), affords chord changes that also align clearly with the notated meter.³² This, too, contrasts with the metrically murky chord changes of the opening D-major wave as well as with the lack of chord changes within the following B-minor wave at the opening of the movement. Needless to say, the Fenaroli appears long after the meter had been established perceptually, yet it elegantly solves one of the opening compositional problems, fitting the inchoate 6-stroke idea into a conventional schema realized in a way that is strongly congruent with the notated meter.

c) A final flourish

With the Fenaroli, we have seen how the artisanal hammer strokes were converted into an interopus schema. Before driving towards a definitive final cadence for the exposition after an evaded attempt (m. 62), the violins engage in an energizing flourish in mm. 67–68 (Example 16). The up and down motions of mm. 67–68 articulate a parallelism on the level of an entire measure and bring to mind Kirnberger's metaphor of an undivided motion. After that point, up-and-down gestures in mm. 69–70 create parallelism on the level of a half measure; the opening of m. 71 suggests a subdivision into quarter notes. The idea of rhythmic diminution and augmentation—involved in articulating various metric levels—is revisited here one more time before the exposition comes to its elided cadential close.

³² Though Gjerdingen might frown upon my anachronistic Roman numerals, his definition of schemata through bass (and soprano) scale degrees and figured-bass symbols directly corresponds to harmonic content that may be represented precisely by Roman numerals (or Roman numeral + soprano skeletal scale degree).

The musical score is presented in three systems. The first system shows a vocal line (soprano) and a piano accompaniment (treble and bass clefs). The second system continues the piano accompaniment with a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic marking. The third system shows the continuation of the piano accompaniment. The score is in G major (one sharp) and 3/4 time. The key signature is G major. The tempo is marked with a common time signature (C). The score is annotated with asterisks (*) and numbers (1, 4, 5, (1)) indicating specific cadential points. The text "Complete Cadence: 1 4 5.....(!)" is written below the third system.

Complete Cadence: 1 4 5.....(!)

Example 16 (continued)

Bach revisits such play upon undivided motion vs. cadential schemata in the third and final movement of this symphony (Example 17): at the conclusion of the latter movement, an undifferentiated ascent through 13 pitches culminates in $\hat{3}$, which triggers a further ascent through

$\hat{3}-\hat{4}-\hat{5}-\hat{6}$, that is, a Deceptive Cadence bass schema string, followed by $\hat{4}-\hat{5}-\hat{1}$, i.e., a Complete Cadence (Gjerdingen 2007). The swarm of undifferentiated sixteenth notes leads to a (“statistical”) local high point on $\hat{3}$, which initiates a conventional Deceptive Cadence $\rightarrow$ Complete Cadence schematic pairing. Of course, the understanding that the highpoint on $\hat{3}$ is a detached, initiating schema event can happen only in retrospect, as the formulaic succession of scale degrees, $\hat{4}-\hat{5}-\hat{6}-\hat{4}-\hat{5}-\hat{1}$, brings the movement to a close.

Deceptive Cadence 3 4 5 6 Complete Cadence 4 5 1

Example 17. Symphony Wq. 183/1, mvt. 3, mm. 102–113.

Much like the hammer strokes at the outset of the first movement represented continuous motion through the space of a triad, the final scalar flourishes represent a continuous, undifferentiated motion of uniform pulsations making their way in a scalar fashion through pitch space. Such gestures quickly connect to formulaic cadence patterns, molding such raw materials in an artisanal fashion and bringing about formal closure. Thus, the ending of the first movement’s exposition

stands in stark contrast to its opening: the gestures in pitch space are now unambiguous and congruent with the piece's notated metric levels.

5. *Conclusion*

Our analytical journey through Bach's symphonic exposition is now complete: as opening tonal and metric problems subside once Prinners-riposte leads the piece safely to a home-ley *Quintabsatz*, the piece revisits some of the same opening materials in more conventional guises as part of the script of resting points of a galant sonata exposition: the ambiguous fantasy-like gestures are now embedded clearly in the notated meter, in the expected course of events tonally, and in the punctuation script of the galant sonata exposition. Materials that were enigmatic at first find a conventional, schematic (or formulaic) place, thereby solving the compositional problems of the beginning of the piece. Thus, the exposition provides an intriguing listening puzzle to various types of listeners: it is likely that many listeners can appreciate the resolution of the meter-finding problem, while other patterns (e.g., galant schemata embedded within a particular formal position) would be more recognizable to those more intimately familiar with the galant style. I hope that my analytical exploration would encourage others to engage this fascinating piece and offer further, divergent interpretations of it.

A secondary thread explored here after Ferris (2000) is the possibility that Bach intended this as a compositional commentary on some of Kirnberger's ideas. Though it seems risky to argue that a symphony movement is a coded theoretical commentary, several factors hint that a connection is possible. As Ferris (2000) stresses, Bach's late addition to the free-fantasy chapter was a rare occasion in which the composer engaged directly in a theoretical polemic. Bach's compositional play in this movement suggests an equivalence between metric play and tonal deceptions, perhaps reacting to emerging theoretical notions about meter. Moreover, the bassoon's galant line pitted against the oboes strict counterpoint also suggests an engagement of Kirnberger's ideas about

dissonance treatment, essential dissonances, and the galant and strict styles. While my observations are surely speculative, I hope to have made a plausible case that the piece provides not only an exciting listening journey, but perhaps also a composed reflection on theoretical issues.

Works Cited

- Albrechtsberger, Johann Georg. 1793–c.1807. *Ausweichungen von C-dur und C-moll in die übrigen Dur- und Moll-Töne; Inganni: Trug-Schlüsse, per l'organo o pianoforte; Unterricht über den Gebrauch der verminderten und übermässigen Intervallen*. Leipzig: Peters and Vienna: Cappi.
- Bach, Carl Philipp Emanuel. 1753/1762. *Versuch über die wahre Art das Clavier zu spielen*. Berlin: Henning/Winter.
- Brown, Matthew. 2010. “C. P. E. Bach, Schenker, Improvisation, and Composition.” *Intégral* 24: 1–27.
- Browne, Richmond. 1981. “Tonal Implications of the Diatonic Set.” *In Theory Only* 5 (6–7): 3–21.
- Burstein, L. Poundie. 2020. *Journeys through Galant Expositions*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Byros, Vasili. 2012. “Meyer’s Anvil: Revisiting the Schema Concept.” *Music Analysis* 31 (3): 273–346.
- , 2015. “‘Haupttrübepuncte des Geistes’: Punctuation Schemas and the Late-Eighteenth-Century Sonata.” In *What is a Cadence? Theoretical and Analytical Perspectives on Cadences in the Classical Repertoire*. Eds. Pieter Bergé and Markus Neuwirth. 215–52. Leuven: Leuven University Press.
- , 2022 [online pre-publication]. “Of Elegant Tones and Fantastical Progressions: A Historical, Schema-Based, and Comprovisational Perspective on Diminished Seventh-Chord Modulation, c. 1720–1830. Or, an Exercise in *corporis studium*.” In Daniel Shanahan, John Ashley Burgoyne, and Ian Quinn (eds.), *Oxford Handbook of Music and Corpus Studies*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Caplin, William E. 1998. *Classical Form: A Theory of Formal Functions for the Instrumental Music of Haydn, Mozart, and Beethoven*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- , 2015. “Harmony and Cadence in Gjerdingen’s ‘Prinner.’” In *What Is a Cadence? Theoretical and Analytical Perspectives on Cadences in the Classical Repertoire*. Eds. Pieter Bergé and Markus Neuwirth. 17–58. Leuven: Leuven University Press.
- Clark, Stephen L. (Ed., trans.) 1997. *The Letters of C. P. E. Bach*. Oxford: Clarendon Press.
- Ferris, David. 2000. “C. P. E. Bach and the Art of Strange Modulation.” *Music Theory Spectrum* 22 (1): 60–88.

- Gjerdingen, Robert O. 2007. *Music in the Galant Style*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Haimo, Ethan 1996. "Atonality, Analysis, and the Intentional Fallacy." *Music Theory Spectrum* 18 (2): 167–199.
- Hamilton, Kenneth. 2008. *After the Golden Age: Romantic Pianism and Modern Performance*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Hepokoski, James, and Warren Darcy. 2006. *Elements of Sonata Theory: Norms, Types, and Deformations in the Late-Eighteenth-Century Sonata*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Kidger, David (ed.) 2005. *Carl Philipp Emanuel Bach: The Complete Works III/3: Orchester-Sinfonien mit zwölf obligaten Stimmen Wq 183/1–4*. Accessed online, May 31st, 2023: <https://www.cpebach.org/toc/toc-III-3.html>
- Kirnberger, Johann Philipp. 1982 [1771, 1776]. *The Art of Strict Musical Composition* [Vol. I and Vol. II, part I]. Trans. David Beach and Jürgen Thym. New Have: Yale University Press.
- [Kirnberger, Johann Philipp, and Johann Abraham Peter Schulz]. 1774. "Rhythmus." In Johann Georg Sulzer, *Allgemeine Theorie der schönen Künste*, [1st ed.], Part II, 975–985. Leipzig: Weidmanns, Erben, & Reich. Accessed online, June 2nd, 2023: <https://play.google.com/books/reader?id=z-FMAAAAcAAJ&pg=GBS.PA565&hl=en>
- [Kirnberger, Johann Philipp, and Johann Abraham Peter Schulz.] 1794. "Rhythmus." In Johann Georg Sulzer, *Allgemeine Theorie der schönen Künste*, 4th ed., 4:90–105. Leipzig: In der Weidmannschen Buchhandlung. Reprint, Hildesheim: Georg Olms, 1967.
- Klorman, Edward. 2016. *Mozart's Music of Friends: Social Interplay in the Chamber Works*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Krebs, Harald. 1999. *Fantasy Pieces: Metrical Dissonance in the Music of Robert Schumann*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Lerdahl, Fred, and Ray Jackendoff. 1983. *A Generative Theory of Tonal Music*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
- London, Justin. 2012. *Hearing in Time: Psychological Aspects of Musical Meter* (2nd edition). New York: Oxford University Press.
- Meyer, Leonard B. 1989. *Explaining Music: History, Theory, and Ideology*. Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press.
- , 1998. "A Universe of Universals." *Journal of Musicology* 16 (1): 3–25.
- Mirka, Danuta. 2009. *Metric Manipulations in Haydn and Mozart: Chamber Music for Strings, 1787–1791*. New York: Oxford University Press.

- Schmalfeldt, Janet. 2011. *In the Process of Becoming: Analytic and Philosophical Perspectives on Form in Early Nineteenth-Century Music*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Suchalla, Ernst (ed.). 1994. *Carl Philipp Emanuel Bach: Briefe und Dokumente Kritische Gesamtausgabe*. Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht.
- Temperley, David. 2008. "Hypermetrical Transitions." *Music Theory Spectrum* 30 (2): 305–25.
- Yust, Jason. 2018. *Organized Time: Rhythm, Tonality, and Form*. New York: Oxford University Press.